Sequence model: A0 (travel agent at the counter)

We watched one morning at the counter (11:25 am to 12 pm). A0 also told us about one past case. There are 3 tasks with different triggers, so 3 sequences, each with its own primary intent, plus the past case (AE07).

A0's role (context for all sequences, not a sequence intent)
Advise, take responsibility, fix things when they go wrong. A0 added: "and know the suppliers" (wrap-up; A0-11).

Trigger / outcome · Trigger (mid-way) · Step · Another person's action · Decision · Path not taken / not seen · Breakdown · Loop

Codes show where each item comes from: UE / AE = interview notes; U0- / A0- = team notes after the interview; wrap-up = summary at the end of the interview.

Sequence 1: See what is waiting

Primary intent: Know what is waiting to be done

Trigger
Start of the observed work at the counter, 11:25 am
AE01

Only the time is recorded; what prompts A0 is not (AE01).

See what is waiting

Opens the system (some pending chats) and the shared email inbox
AE01

On the screen: a paper sticky note, "call customer X" (AE01). It is outside the system and the email (see artifact model). The notes do not say if A0 acted on it.

Sequence 2: Answer a request by email

Primary intent: Answer the customer's request (we did not see A0 reply)

Trigger
A new request in the shared inbox
AE02

Read the request

Reads: "I saw similar places for 10 or 20 euros less per night"
AE02

Price pressure: the customer compares with cheaper similar places (AE02 [BD], A0-02)

A0 sighs: "Here we go again." This is a feeling, not a step; it goes in the cultural model.

Outcome
We did not see the reply

Sequence 3: Help a couple at the counter

Primary intent: Give the couple a trip that can work, as an offer (our reading of AE03–AE06)

Trigger
A couple comes in with a printed plan: "something like this"
AE03

1. Understand what the couple wants

Intent
Understand what the couple really wants

Secondary intent
• *Find out how flexible they are (A0-06)*

Asks about budget, flexible dates and "what you won't give up"
AE03

The couple's plan did not answer these questions (A0-06).

2. Check if the plan works

Intent
Avoid a trip that cannot work

Reads the printed plan: ideas, flights, where they want to stay
AE03, AE04

Does the plan work?
yes → *Not seen in this case*
no

Shows that two cities are 6 h apart by train and a monument is closed that day
AE04

The plan cannot work; A0 has to be the "killjoy" (A0-05)

The couple look at each other, unhappy
AE04

3. Prepare the offer

Intent
Send the offer to the couple "as soon as possible"

Copies data from the booking portal into the agency template (with logo)
AE05

Looking for and copying data between systems takes "most of the morning" (wrap-up, A0-07).

Promises to email the offer "as soon as possible"
AE05

The couple say thanks and that they will "think about it and compare online"
AE06

Customers get advice at the agency, then compare online on their own (A0-08).

Outcome
No decision at the counter
AE06

Past case (AE07): The service fee

Primary intent: Charge the service fee (A0-03)

A0 told us about this case while we watched. We did not see it happen.

Trigger
Not recorded: AE07 only says the customer refused

Charge for the service

The customer will not pay: "the website doesn't charge that"
AE07

The customer refuses the fee because the website does not charge one (A0-03)

Outcome
A0 loses the customer
AE07